

Character Classes

Most D&D characters will be humans. A human may be a cleric, fighter, magic-user, or thief. Humans are the most wide-spread of all races. The human traits of curiosity, courage, and resourcefulness have helped them to adapt, survive, and prosper everywhere they have gone.

Some players may wish to have demi-human characters (elves, dwarves, or halflings). Each type of demi-human is a class in itself. The demi-human races are cousin species to humans. Each character class is further explained hereafter.

CLERICS

Clerics are humans who have dedicated themselves to the service of a god or goddess. They are trained in fighting and casting spells. As a cleric advances in level, he or she is granted the use of more and more spells. However, clerics do *not* receive any spells until they reach 2nd level (and have proven their devotion to their god or goddess). A list of clerical spells and their explanations is given in **Part 3: SPELLS**. The prime requisite for clerics is Wisdom. A Wisdom score of 13 or greater will give the cleric a bonus on earned experience points.

RESTRICTIONS: Clerics use six-sided dice (d6) to determine their hit points. They may wear any armor and may use shields. Clerics are forbidden by their religious codes from using edged weapons, such as swords and arrows. A cleric may only use a weapon without an edge, such as a mace or sling.

SPECIAL ABILITIES: Clerics are very helpful when **undead** monsters (such as skeletons, zombies, and ghouls) are encountered. When a cleric encounters an **undead** monster, the cleric may attempt to "Turn" (scare) the monster instead of fighting it. If a cleric **Turns** an **undead** monster, the monster will not touch the cleric and will flee from the area if it can.

When a cleric attempts to **Turn** one or more of the undead, consult the **Clerics vs. Undead** table (page B8). Cross-index the cleric's level with the type of undead encountered. The result will be "**no effect**", a **number**, or a **T**.

"**No effect**" means that the cleric cannot **Turn** that type of undead monster (the cleric has not yet gained enough experience to do so).

A **number** means that the cleric has a chance at **Turning** some or all of the undead monsters. If the player rolls the given number (or greater) on 2d6, then some of the undead monsters are **Turned**. If the cleric rolls less than the given number, the attempt to **Turn** the undead monster fails (as in "no effect").

A "**T**" means that the cleric automatically **Turns** some or all of the undead monsters.

If a cleric is successful at **Turning** some undead monsters, the player must roll 2d6 to find how many **hit dice** of undead monsters are **Turned**. A successful attempt at **Turning** undead will always affect at least one undead monster, no matter how few **hit dice** are affected.

EXAMPLE: Father Miles (a 3rd level cleric) meets 5 ghouls (2 hit dice each) in a tomb. The player finds Father Miles' level (3) in the "Cleric's Level" column of the **Clerics vs. Undead** table, and then reads across the table to the "Ghouls" column. According to the chart, he must roll a 7 or greater (on 2d6) to turn them; his roll is an 8, and he is successful. He rolls again to see how many monsters he turns. The result of 9 means that 4 ghouls (a total of 8 hit dice worth) are turned away (extra hit dice have no effect). After the remaining ghoul is slain, 6 skeletons attack from another direction. According to the chart, Father Miles automatically turns them. He rolls a 5 (on 2d6), and since the skeletons have 1 hit dice each, all but one turn and run away.

DWARVES

Dwarves are short, stocky demi-humans about four feet tall. All dwarves have long beards. They weigh about 150 pounds. Their skin is earth-colored and their hair is dark brown, gray, or black. Stubborn but practical, dwarves love hearty meals and strong drink. They value good craftsmanship, and are very fond of gold. Dwarves are sturdy fighters and are especially resistant to magic, as shown by their better saving throws against magical attacks. The prime requisite for a dwarf character is Strength. A Strength score of 13 or greater will give a dwarf a bonus on earned experience points.

RESTRICTIONS: Dwarves use eight-sided dice (d8) to determine their hit points. They may advance to a maximum of 12th level of experience. Dwarves may use any type of armor and may use shields. They may use any type of weapon of normal or small size, but may not use long bows nor two-handed swords. A dwarf character must have a minimum Constitution score of 9.

SPECIAL ABILITIES: Dwarves are very hardy creatures and have better saving throws than most other character classes. Dwarves often live underground, and have **infravision** (heat-sensing sight) which allows them to see 60 feet in the dark. They are expert miners and are able to find slanting passages, traps, shifting walls, and new construction one-third of the time (a roll of 1 or 2 on 1d6) when looking for them. All dwarves speak Common, Dwarvish, and the alignment tongue of the character, plus the languages of gnomes, kobolds, and goblins.

ELVES

Elves are slender, graceful demi-humans with delicate features and slightly pointed ears. They are 5 to 5½ feet tall and weigh about 120 pounds. They can be dangerous opponents, able to fight with any weapon and use magic spells as well, but prefer to spend their time feasting and frolicking in wooded glades. They rarely visit the cities of men. Elves are fascinated by magic and never grow tired of collecting spells and magic items, especially if the items are beautifully crafted.

The prime requisites for an elf are Strength and Intelligence. If an elf has a score of 13 or greater in *both* Strength and Intelligence, the character will gain a 5% bonus on earned experience points. If the elf's Strength is 13 or greater *and* his or her Intelligence is 16 or greater, that character will earn a 10% bonus on earned experience.

RESTRICTIONS: Elves use six-sided dice (d6) to determine their hit points. They may advance to a maximum of 10th level of experience. Elves have the advantages of both fighters and magic-users. They may use shields and can wear any type of armor, and may fight with any kind of weapon. They can also cast spells like a magic-user, and use the same spell list. A character must have an intelligence of 9 or greater to be an elf.

SPECIAL ABILITIES: Elves have **infravision** (heat-sensing sight) and can see 60 feet in the dark. When looking for secret or hidden doors, elves are able to find them one-third of the time (a roll of 1 or 2 on 1d6). Elves cannot be paralyzed by the attacks of ghouls. All elves speak Common, Elvish, and the alignment tongue of the character, plus the languages of orcs, hobgoblins, and gnolls.